

Process & Decision Documentation

Side Quest 5, Date Used: Feb 23, 2026, Iba Abbasi 21086411

1. What I Was Trying to Do

I made a reflective camera experience for this Side Quest, in which the player navigates a world that is bigger than the screen that is visible. In contrast to a fast-paced or goal-driven gaming experience, the primary objective was to create a serene and meditative atmosphere through the use of slow movement, fluid camera motion, and visual pacing.

I concentrated on the atmosphere rather than difficulties or barriers. The world scrolls slowly to promote silent exploration, and the camera follows the player fluidly with easing. Rather than stressing competition or urgency, I emphasized motion and scale in my design to create an air of openness and space.

2. One Small Decision or Change I Made

One important choice I made was to use camera easing instead of having the camera snap right to the player's position. Instead of quickly centering on the player, the camera slowly moves toward its target position.

This little change made a big difference in how the experience felt emotionally. The movement feels softer and more purposeful, which fits with the reflective theme of the assignment. It also supports the idea that pacing and movement can convey emotion without any dialogue or narrative text.

3. GenAI Use

I used GenAI to help me organize the camera logic and make the experience flow better. I asked for help putting the code into clearer functions (like player update, camera update, and rendering layers) and for ideas on how to make the motion feel more meditative. I looked over the suggestions that were made and changed them, changed the speed and easing values of the movement, and made some parts simpler to better fit with my design goals. I made sure that the camera constraints and world bounds worked as they should and that the final structure showed how I understood how camera translation works in p5.js.

GenAI transcript:

<https://chatgpt.com/share/699cfd2b-d47c-8004-85a5-6e07db65fc4b>

4. Minimal Evidence

- Comments in the code explaining camera easing and world clamping
- Screenshot(s) showing the world extending beyond the visible screen
- Screenshot(s) demonstrating hidden symbols discovered through exploration